🏛 History — Master File (Ancient · Medieval · Modern) · SSC CGL

> **The single consolidated History resource** for SSC CGL — Ancient, Medieval & Modern India, with high-yield PYQ-pattern questions, freshly-created questions, and a rapid revision sheet. Weightage 🔴 High per the PYQ Pattern Blueprint.

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1. What SSC Repeats in History

Per the 5-year PYQ pattern, SSC keeps returning to these clusters (learn these first):

🔴 High	🟡 Medium
Buddhism & Jainism · Mauryan (Ashoka) · Gupta (Golden Age) · Mughal **administration** · Freedom Movement · **Revolt of 1857** · Acts & Constitutional development	Bhakti Movement · Delhi Sultanate · Vijayanagara · Marathas

> SSC asks **direct** questions (who started it? which year? objective? outcome?). Skip obscure dates and minor regional wars.

2. Ancient India

Indus Valley Civilisation (IVC / Harappan)

- **Period:** c. 2500–1700 BCE (Mature Harappan c. 2600–1900 BCE); **Bronze Age**, urban.
- **Discovery:** Harappa — 1921 (Daya Ram Sahni); Mohenjodaro — 1922 (R. D. Banerji).
- **Town planning:** grid pattern, burnt-brick houses, **Great Bath** (Mohenjodaro), Great Granary, covered drainage.
- **Key sites:** Harappa (Ravi) · Mohenjodaro (Indus) · **Lothal** (Gujarat — dockyard) · **Kalibangan** (Rajasthan — ploughed field, fire altars) · **Dholavira** (Gujarat — water management) · **Rakhigarhi** (Haryana — largest site in India).
- **Script:** pictographic, undeciphered, right-to-left. Worshipped **Pashupati** (proto-Shiva) & Mother Goddess. **No temples** found.

Vedic Period

- **Rigveda** — oldest Veda; Samaveda (music), Yajurveda (rituals), Atharvaveda (magic/medicine).
- **Gayatri Mantra** — from the Rigveda. **"Satyameva Jayate"** — from the Mundaka Upanishad.

Buddhism & Jainism (🔴 high-yield)

- **Gautama Buddha:** born 563 BCE at **Lumbini** (Nepal) · Enlightenment at **Bodh Gaya** · first sermon at **Sarnath** · death (Mahaparinirvana) at **Kushinagar**. Four Noble Truths; Eightfold Path.
- **Mahavira:** 24th Tirthankara; born at Kundagrama (Vaishali); Triratna (Three Jewels). First Tirthankara: **Rishabhanatha**.

Mauryan Empire (322–185 BCE)

- **Founder:** Chandragupta Maurya (322 BCE), aided by **Chanakya (Kautilya)**, author of *Arthashastra*. Capital: **Pataliputra**.
- **Megasthenes** (Greek ambassador) wrote *Indica*.
- **Ashoka the Great** (268–232 BCE): **Kalinga War (261 BCE)** → conversion to Buddhism. Edicts in Brahmi/Kharoshthi. The **Sarnath Lion Capital** = India's National Emblem.
- Last Mauryan Brihadratha killed by **Pushyamitra Shunga**.

Gupta Empire — Golden Age (c. 320–550 CE)

- Founder Sri Gupta; **Chandragupta I** started the Gupta era.
- **Samudragupta** — "Napoleon of India" (Allahabad Prashasti by Harisena).
- **Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya):** Fa-Hien visited; **Navaratnas** incl. **Kalidasa**.
- **Aryabhata** (zero, value of pi), Varahamihira. **Iron Pillar of Delhi**. Nalanda under Kumaragupta I.

Other Ancient

- **Harshavardhana** (606–647 CE): capital Kannauj; **Hiuen Tsang** visited.
- **Cholas:** Rajaraja I built **Brihadeeswarar Temple** (Thanjavur); strong navy.

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3. Medieval India

Delhi Sultanate (1206–1526)

- **Slave/Mamluk (1206–90):** Qutb-ud-din Aibak (founder, began Qutub Minar) · **Iltutmish** (silver tanka, copper jital) · **Razia Sultan** (first & only woman ruler of Delhi) · Balban.
- **Khilji (1290–1320): Alauddin Khilji** — market/price control, repelled Mongols; Malik Kafur invaded the south.
- **Tughlaq (1320–1414): Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq** — capital Delhi→Daulatabad, token currency · Firoz Shah Tughlaq — canals, Firozabad.
- **Sayyid (1414–51)** & **Lodi (1451–1526):** Ibrahim Lodi killed by Babur at **First Battle of Panipat (1526)**.

Vijayanagara & Bahmani

- **Vijayanagara** founded 1336 by **Harihara & Bukka** (Sangama); **Krishnadevaraya** (peak); capital **Hampi**; lost at the **Battle of Talikota (1565)**.

Bhakti & Sufi

- **Bhakti saints:** Kabir, Guru Nanak, Ramananda, Mirabai, Tulsidas, Chaitanya. **Sufi orders:** Chishti (Moinuddin Chishti — Ajmer), Suhrawardi.

Mughal Empire (1526–1857)

- **Babur (1526)** — founder; *Baburnama*; First Battle of Panipat.

- **Humayun** — beaten by **Sher Shah Suri** (Chausa 1539, Kannauj 1540); Sher Shah built the **Grand Trunk Road**, introduced the **rupiya**.
- **Akbar (1556–1605):** Second Battle of Panipat; **Din-i-Ilahi**; **Mansabdari**; abolished **jizya**; Navaratnas (Birbal, Tansen, Todar Mal, Abul Fazl → *Akbarnama/Ain-i-Akbari*). Built Fatehpur Sikri, Buland Darwaza.
- **Jahangir** — Nur Jahan; envoy **Sir Thomas Roe**.
- **Shah Jahan** — **Taj Mahal**, Red Fort & Jama Masjid; peak of architecture.
- **Aurangzeb** — re-imposed jizya; greatest extent; clashed with Marathas/Sikhs. **Bahadur Shah Zafar** = last Mughal.
- **Mughal administration (🔴 focus):** Mansabdari (rank system), Zabti/revenue system (Todar Mal's bandobast), Jagirdari.

Marathas

- **Shivaji** crowned 1674 at Raigad; **Ashtapradhan** (council of 8).

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4. Modern India & Freedom Struggle

European Arrival & British Rule

- Sea route to India: **Vasco da Gama** (1498, via Cape of Good Hope). First European traders: **Portuguese** (HQ Goa). First British fort (Calcutta): **Fort William**.
- **Battle of Plassey (1757):** Robert Clive beat Siraj-ud-Daulah → British foothold in Bengal.
- **Battle of Buxar (1764):** British won **Diwani** rights (Bengal, Bihar, Odisha, 1765).
- **First Governor-General:** Warren Hastings · **Last Viceroy:** Lord Mountbatten.
- **Land revenue systems:** Permanent Settlement (Zamindari, Cornwallis), Ryotwari (peasant→govt), Mahalwari.

Socio-Religious Reforms

- **Raja Rammohan Roy** — abolition of **Sati (1829)**; Brahmo Samaj. **Dayanand Saraswati** — Arya Samaj ("Back to the Vedas"). **Vivekananda** — Ramakrishna Mission.

Revolt of 1857 (First War of Independence) 🔴

- Began **10 May 1857 at Meerut**; immediate cause — **greased cartridges** (Enfield). Early figure: **Mangal Pandey** (Barrackpore) — first martyr.
- **Leaders:** Delhi — Bahadur Shah Zafar · Kanpur — Nana Sahib & Tantia Tope · Jhansi — **Rani Lakshmibai** · Lucknow — Begum Hazrat Mahal · Bihar — Kunwar Singh.
- **Result:** end of Company rule; **Government of India Act 1858** → power to the British Crown.

INC & Sessions

- Founded **1885** by **A. O. Hume**; first session Bombay 1885, president **W. C. Bonnerjee**.
- **Surat Split (1907)** — Moderates vs Extremists.
- **Lahore Session (1929)** — **"Purna Swaraj"** (Nehru); 26 Jan 1930 first Independence Day.
- **Karachi Session (1931)** — Fundamental Rights resolution.
- First woman INC president: **Annie Besant (1917)**; first Indian woman: **Sarojini Naidu (1925)**.

Movements & Dates (🔴 direct questions)

- **Swadeshi Movement** — 1905 (Partition of Bengal).
- **Home Rule** — 1916 (Tilak & Annie Besant). Tilak: "Swaraj is my birthright."
- **Jallianwala Bagh** — **13 April 1919**, Amritsar (Gen. Dyer).

- **Non-Cooperation** — 1920–22; called off after **Chauri Chaura** (Feb 1922).
- **Simon Commission** — 1928 ("Simon Go Back"; Lala Lajpat Rai injured).
- **Civil Disobedience / Dandi Salt March** — 12 Mar–6 Apr **1930** (Sabarmati → Dandi).
- **Round Table Conferences** — 1930, 1931, 1932; Gandhi attended the 2nd.
- **Poona Pact** — 1932 (Gandhi–Ambedkar).
- **Quit India** — **8 August 1942** ("Do or Die"; Bombay).
- **Revolutionaries:** Bhagat Singh/Sukhdev/Rajguru; Chandrashekhar Azad; **Surya Sen** (Chittagong armoury raid, 1930).
- **INA (Azad Hind Fauj)** — **Subhas Chandra Bose** ("Dilli Chalo", "Jai Hind").
- **Independence: 15 August 1947** (Indian Independence Act 1947, Mountbatten Plan).

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5. Curated PYQ-Pattern Questions

Q1. Indus Valley site known for its dockyard — (a) Harappa (b) **Lothal** (c) Kalibangan (d) Dholavira

Q2. Author of *Arthashastra* — (a) Megasthenes (b) Kalidasa (c) **Chanakya** (d) Banabhatta

Q3. Kalinga War was fought by — (a) Chandragupta (b) Bindusara (c) **Ashoka** (d) Brihadratha

Q4. "Napoleon of India" — (a) Chandragupta II (b) **Samudragupta** (c) Skandagupta (d) Kumaragupta

Q5. Buddha attained enlightenment at — (a) Lumbini (b) Sarnath (c) **Bodh Gaya** (d) Kushinagar

Q6. First & only woman ruler of Delhi — (a) Nur Jahan (b) **Razia Sultan** (c) Chand Bibi (d) Rani Durgavati

Q7. Capital Delhi→Daulatabad — (a) Alauddin (b) Firoz Shah (c) **Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq** (d) Balban

Q8. First Battle of Panipat (1526): Babur vs — (a) Rana Sanga (b) **Ibrahim Lodi** (c) Sher Shah (d) Hemu

Q9. Grand Trunk Road & rupiya — (a) Akbar (b) **Sher Shah Suri** (c) Babur (d) Aurangzeb

Q10. Taj Mahal built by — (a) Akbar (b) Jahangir (c) **Shah Jahan** (d) Aurangzeb

Q11. Lion Capital of Ashoka is at — (a) Bodh Gaya (b) **Sarnath** (c) Sanchi (d) Kushinagar

Q12. Mughal emperor who abolished jizya — (a) Babur (b) **Akbar** (c) Aurangzeb (d) Jahangir *(Aurangzeb re-imposed it)*

Q13. "Purna Swaraj" was adopted at — (a) Karachi (b) Surat (c) **Lahore (1929)** (d) Bombay

Q14. Dandi March (Salt Satyagraha) year — (a) 1920 (b) 1928 (c) **1930** (d) 1942

Q15. Act transferring power to the British Crown — (a) 1773 (b) 1833 (c) **1858** (d) 1909

Q16. Battle of Plassey (1757) won by — (a) Hastings (b) **Robert Clive** (c) Dalhousie (d) Wellesley

Q17. Revolt of 1857 began at — (a) Delhi (b) Kanpur (c) **Meerut** (d) Jhansi

Q18. INC founded in — (a) 1857 (b) **1885** (c) 1905 (d) 1919

Q19. "Do or Die" slogan → movement — (a) Non-Cooperation (b) Civil Disobedience (c) **Quit India** (d) Swadeshi

Q20. Indian Councils Act 1909 is also called — (a) Montagu-Chelmsford (b) **Minto-Morley** (c) Parliament Act (d) GoI Act

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6. Freshly-Created Practice Questions

New questions in the SSC pattern; answer key at the end.

N1. The largest Indus Valley site found in India is —

(a) Lothal (b) Kalibangan (c) Rakhigarhi (d) Dholavira

N2. The Gayatri Mantra is found in the —

(a) Samaveda (b) Rigveda (c) Yajurveda (d) Atharvaveda

N3. Fa-Hien, the Chinese pilgrim, visited India during the reign of —

(a) Ashoka (b) Harshavardhana (c) Chandragupta II (d) Samudragupta

N4. The Battle of Talikota (1565) led to the fall of which empire?

(a) Bahmani (b) Vijayanagara (c) Maratha (d) Chola

N5. Who introduced the Mansabdari system?

(a) Babur (b) Sher Shah (c) Akbar (d) Aurangzeb

N6. The abolition of Sati (1829) is associated with —

(a) Dayanand Saraswati (b) Raja Rammohan Roy (c) Vivekananda (d) Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar

N7. The Non-Cooperation Movement was called off after the —

(a) Jallianwala Bagh massacre (b) Chauri Chaura incident (c) Simon Commission (d) Poona Pact

N8. "Swaraj is my birthright and I shall have it" was said by —

(a) Gandhi (b) Nehru (c) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (d) Bhagat Singh

N9. The Chittagong armoury raid (1930) was led by —

(a) Bhagat Singh (b) Surya Sen (c) Chandrashekhar Azad (d) Sukhdev

N10. The Diwani rights of Bengal, Bihar and Odisha were granted to the British after the —

(a) Battle of Plassey (b) Battle of Buxar (c) Battle of Wandiwash (d) Third Battle of Panipat

Answer Key (Section 6):

N1-(c) Rakhigarhi · N2-(b) Rigveda · N3-(c) Chandragupta II · N4-(b) Vijayanagara · N5-(c) Akbar · N6-(b) Raja Rammohan Roy · N7-(b) Chauri Chaura · N8-(c) Tilak · N9-(b) Surya Sen · N10-(b) Battle of Buxar

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7. Rapid Revision Sheet

- IVC discovered: Harappa 1921, Mohenjodaro 1922 · Lothal → dockyard · Rakhigarhi → largest in India
- *Arthashastra* → Chanakya · Mauryan founder → Chandragupta Maurya · Kalinga War → Ashoka (261 BCE)
- "Napoleon of India" → Samudragupta · Golden Age → Gupta · Aryabhata → zero
- Buddha: Lumbini (born) → Bodh Gaya (enlightenment) → Sarnath (sermon) → Kushinagar (death)
- Mahavira → 24th Tirthankara · First Tirthankara → Rishabhanatha
- First woman ruler of Delhi → Razia Sultan · Capital Delhi→Daulatabad → Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq
- Vijayanagara → Hampi; fell at Talikota (1565) · First Battle of Panipat → 1526 (Babur v Ibrahim Lodi)
- Grand Trunk Road/rupiya → Sher Shah · Mansabdari & abolished jizya → Akbar · Taj Mahal → Shah Jahan
- Plassey → 1757 (Clive) · Buxar → 1764 (Diwani) · First GG → Warren Hastings; last Viceroy → Mountbatten
- Sati abolished 1829 → Rammohan Roy · Revolt of 1857 → Meerut, 10 May; GoI Act 1858 → Crown rule

- INC founded 1885 (Hume); first president Bonnerjee · Purna Swaraj → Lahore 1929
- Jallianwala Bagh → 13 Apr 1919 · Non-Cooperation 1920–22 (Chauri Chaura) · Dandi/Salt → 1930
- Quit India → 8 Aug 1942 ("Do or Die") · INA → Subhas Chandra Bose · Independence → 15 Aug 1947

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